category of Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs).

There is another category of people who may have lost their nationality by certain laws of a country. Further, they may not be considered as nationals by any country. They are disowned by any country. These people, then as per the United Nations Convention Relating to the Status of Stateless persons, are **stateless people** [Article 1]. These people then might be forcibly evicted or have to leave the country under compulsion. Since their legal status is undetermined they suffer a lot of hardship and denial to access to minimum basic facilities. They may seek asylum in another country. Then they will be put under the category of ‘asylum seekers’. If that country grants them asylum and recognizes them as refugees, to some extent their hardships get mitigated. The international agencies like the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) might provide humanitarian assistance. This is a difficult process and depends upon various political and security considerations of host countries.

The UNHCR estimates that till the end of 2018 there are about 70.8 million forcibly displaced persons around the globe. There are about 41.3 million Internally Displaced Persons globally. Refugees account for 25.9 million people. Whereas, 3.5 million people fall in the category of asylum seekers. The largest number of asylum seekers came from Venezuela in the year 2018. Syria, South Sudan and Afghanistan are three of the largest refugee producing countries. About 57% of refugees came from these three countries.

Specifically now, turning towards those migrants who are categorized as ‘refugees’, will be the focus of our discussion. Though in common parlance refugees, migrants and asylum seekers are not differentiated but under international law there are differences among them which are discussed in the next section.